When I Shatter

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Multi

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora/Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra/Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra & Entrapta & Scorpia (She-Ra)

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When I Shatter

by catrasb00bwindow

Summary

Catra gets out of prison and tries begin a fragile new life. The last thing she needs is a soulmate (or two) messing it all up.

Notes

Hiiiii! this is a project i started 2 years ago, which ive decided to post now. is the she-ra fandom still alive?

if you are my bf, go away :3

anyone else, i hope you enjoy.

See the end of the work for more notes

"Fear of the present leads to a mystification of the past. The past is not for living in; it is a well of conclusions from which we draw in order to act."

While this may be true, Catra's view of the past was somewhat skewed.

Blood ran off Catra's hand and down her arm, forming a pool on the floor at her feet.

Because of this, we must begin this story in the past.

Catra's train was late. Rush Hour slows everything down. She looked down at her feet. She was tired.

Catra sat down on an empty seat in the last carriage, once the train arrived. She turned her head away and stared at the trees outside her window. Thoughts picked up like a dust storm, whirling around her head. It felt like everything around her was buzzing. She looked down at the ground and squeezed her eyes shut.

The sound of the train rattling on the tracks filled her sensitive cat ears. She tried not to focus on it, but it was just so loud. Her heavy shoes felt far too tight around her feet. She wrenched them off, frustrated. They slumped against each other, looking sad. She dragged her knees to her chest and sank back into the seat, but the feeling of the fabric made her want to vomit. Clearly, being in prison had really messed with her senses.

She crawled out of her seat and staggered to the toilet, feeling like she was going to be sick any second. She did throw up in the toilet, wiping her mouth with the back of her hand. She turned to the mirror, but the train was shaking, making it difficult to focus on her shape. Her makeup was smudged, and her hair messy. It had mostly grown back after it was cut when she went into prison. She swept it back into a ponytail, vowing to keep it like

that, trying desperately to create a new identity. Something far from the person she was 5 years ago.

The walk back to her seat went more smoothly than the walk to the bathroom, and when she sat down, the fabric didn't feel as disgusting.

She put her head against the wall and closed her eyes, wishing for sleep to come. Anything to stop feeling this. Eventually she pulled out her phone and the cheap earphones that she had bought from the station. She turned the volume up high to drown out the suffocating noise of the train. This worked for a while, until the noise around her seeped into her ears, making everything unbearable. She tugged out her earphones anything but carefully. Catra let out a sigh, squeezing her eyes, she refused to let tears come. She fell into an uneasy sleep, dreaming of everything she could have changed.

She remained in this state of sensory-overwhelm until the conductor passed her seat, asking to see her ticket and some ID. Catra picked up her head again, realising she was being spoken to. Blinking a few times, she began to search her bag, trying to find her wallet. Once she found it, she removed her driver's licence and the ticket, handing them to the conductor.

He marked the ticket, and checked her ID.

"There you go, Elizabeth," He held out her cards for her to take.

Catra took them. It felt strange to hear that name. No one had used it in so long. She rested her head on the wall again, feeling slightly better.

-

Catra awoke to a tall woman tapping her shoulder. She hadn't even realised she had fallen asleep. In an annoyingly British accent, the woman said "The train terminates here. You'll need to get off, unless you want to go right back to where you came from."

Catra turned, intending to thank the woman, but she was already walking away, pink hair cascading down her back.

She stood up, and hauled her bag onto her shoulders, sighing. She trudged down the aisle, passing all of the empty seats. No one was in the carriage, except for a drunk lying in the seats at the end. No one had bothered to help him. Catra didn't either.

Catra stepped onto the platform. The sky above her was dark and murky. Street lamps were lit and people bustled around her, all with a different sense of urgency. She navigated through the train station, keeping her head down. No one noticed her.

Stepping out onto the street was like stepping into a new world. Catra threw her head back in pure delight. Rain splashed on her face. She stared up into the night sky, watching the droplets fall around her. She didn't rush to get out of it; in fact, she welcomed it. Street lights and stars glittered above her. She closed her eyes. Shop windows glowed. Cars and buses rushed past her, throwing splashes of puddles onto the pavement.

Catra opened her phone. It was new; she had got it two weeks ago after her release. It was on full brightness, so she had to squint to look at it in the nighttime air. The time read 10:57. She opened messages to check the address of the apartment. She didn't need to do this though, she already had it memorised. Opening Google Maps, Catra typed in the address. Thankfully, it wasn't too far away.

The little blue dot on the map glowed as she walked. She crossed the road, her breath misting before her. Catra wrapped her arms around herself trying to keep herself warm. She regretted wearing just a hoodie. But it wasn't like she owned a jacket anyway.

Catra walked up the metal staircase. She stopped when she got to the second floor balcony. She wasn't sure how ready she was to go in. Resting her arms on the slippery railing, Catra closed her eyes and listened. Rain pattered on the roof above her. The occasional car passed. A broken drain above her dripped onto

potted plants around her, which then dripped into a puddle on the concrete below her.

She opened her eyes again. Noticing everything around herself was surreal. For a start, it was dark, distorting shapes beyond what they'd look like in daylight. But mostly, things felt so surreal because she'd just spent the last six months in prison.

She remembered a time at the start of her ordeal, before she had become accustomed to the gruelling routine. Not being able to stomach the food, being sick after, whether she ate it or not. No one seemed to care. Not the other inmates. Not the wardens. They just saw her as a burden that they had to clean up after.

Catra stretched her arms and shook herself, not wanting to think about the last six months. She suddenly realised how cold she was. She knocked on the door of number two. Not a second after it was opened she was embraced in a hug. Suddenly an ugly sob hit her ears. It took her a second to realise it was her making it. She let the sobs come freely. There was no stopping it.

"I missed you, Wildcat. So much," Scorpia whispered in Catra's ear.

"I missed you too, Scorpia," Catra sobbed, choking through her tears.

Scorpia eventually broke away from the hug, but Catra kept crying. Scorpia escorted her inside where Entrapta was waiting for her. Entrapta hugged Catra too. It felt a little more awkward, but Catra loved her for it. Scorpia joined in the hug too. After a while, they were all crying.

"We're so glad you're home, Catra. We love you!" Scorpia wailed.

Catra found it almost too hard to speak. "I love you too," she choked through tears. She pulled away from the hug to wipe her eyes, but looking at her friends made her eyes fill with tears again.

“Come on, Wildcat… You’ve had a long night… We should get you to bed,” Scorpia smiled at Catra through her tears.

Catra nodded, unable to stop crying. Scorpia led her through to a small box room off the main room. The room was tiny, with no window, and it was only able to fit a single bed and a chest of drawers. There were a couple of cabinets at the top of the wall, a bedside table and a lamp, but that was it. And it was enough for Catra.

She fell on the bed, not even bothering to take her shoes off. Two towels were sitting on the end, one red, the other white. They unrolled slightly when she landed.

Entrapta came in after a while, initially just to wish her a good night, but she found herself unpacking Catra’s bag, folding her clothes and putting the towels on the chest of drawers. Entrapta pulled Catra’s heavy boots off too, putting them neatly next to the door. She found Catra her pyjamas, toothbrush and toothpaste and threw them to her.

“You should clean your teeth, you know, there’s so many diseases you could get,” Entrapta babbled, folding more clothes. “I was reading about one the other day where-”

Catra cut her off. “That’s enough, Entrapta. I don’t really want to know,” She smiled softly. This was Entrapta’s way of caring for someone. It was nice that Entrapta continued to care for her in the same way she did before… her ordeal.

Once Entratpta had left and the door was closed, Catra stripped off her clothes, throwing them in a corner. She made a mental note to wash them.

It felt good to be wearing her old pyjamas after what seemed like such a long time. They weren’t special or anything, just a worn out pair of joggers and a tee shirt she’d stolen from her childhood best friend when she was 14.

She picked up the toothbrush and tiny tube of toothpaste and wandered through to the bathroom, switching on the light as she entered. Both the toothpaste and toothbrush were shiny new; she'd only bought them at the airport that morning.

Scorpia came in while Catra was brushing her teeth, but she didn't say anything. She just leaned against the doorframe. Catra spat in the sink and turned on the tap before Scorpia could notice the blood.

"What are you doing there?" Catra asked, slightly exasperated by her staring.

"I'm just… checking on you, that's all," Scorpia replied innocently, not noticing Catra's tone.

"You don't need to do that, I swear I'm fine," Catra insisted, trying to stay calm.

"Catra! You don't have to act all tough and independent all the time, you know that!"

"Look... Scoripia… I've just spent the last six months being told what to do… The last thing I need is for you to make it longer,"

Scorpia attempted to stop Catra from leaving the bathroom, trying to convince her that she needed help, but Catra's cold stare was too strong for her.

"Scorpia. I'm fine."

Scorpia gave up. Some part of her knew from the start that it was worthless, but she had ignored it. She watched Catra walking away, tail swishing behind her.

All Scorpia wanted for Catra was that she could find her soulmate. Someone caring, who she could talk to, and… trust. Some part of her hoped she was Catra's soulmate, but it wasn't very likely.

She looked down at her hand, her red string of fate leading vaguely to her soulmate. She followed it with her eyes. It had appeared a few days ago, at a coffee shop. Her first thought was Catra, so she rushed out of the shop excitedly. She hadn't noticed the look on the barista's face. But the way the thread was pointing now? Scorpia sighed. She had no intention of following the string. Not in this state. It was ironic really, that she wanted so much for Catra to find her soulmate, yet she had now intention of finding her own.

Wasn't it a positive trait, to put others before your own?

Despite the bed being comfortable, and the sun not yet risen, Catra still woke up at 6am. And, since there was no chance of getting back to sleep again, Catra sat up and stretched, pulling the covers off her legs. She stretched again, standing up.

The rest of the flat was dark, the curtains drawn and the lights off.

The kitchen was small, like most of the other rooms. Thankfully, it made the coffee easy to find. She put some powder into what she assumed was Entrapta's coffee machine, turned it on and left it to boil.

Catra opened all the cupboards in turn, looking for a suitable mug. Not surprisingly, all the mugs were either tiny, or adapted to scorpion claws.

Luckily, she did find one normal mug at the back of the cupboard. It was white and boring, but Catra poured her coffee into it without a second thought, her claws clicking against the porcelain.

She turned to the window, pulling the cord of the blind, allowing the early morning light stream into the kitchen.

Being mid October, the house was cold, so Catra was grateful for her warm coffee. She drained it in under five minutes, chucking the empty mug into the sink.

Catra grabbed her towels and outfit from her bedroom, snapping on the bathroom light.

The shower was simple enough to figure out, but Catra wasn’t one to enjoy water, so she washed herself as quickly as possible. She turned off the shower, stepping onto the cold tiles, wrapping the towel around herself.

Catra squeezed the water out of her hair, wrapping it in a towel so it wouldn’t drip down her back while she dressed herself.

She only had one outfit anyway; the same she had arrived in. A plain hoodie and cargo pants. Something people wouldn't stare at in the street. I

t wasn’t until she was running product through her hair in the mirror when she noticed it. A dimly glowing string tied to the tip of her pinkie finger. Her eyes widened. It couldn't be… Her… Red string of fate? Her soulmate couldn't be here in Brightmoon… Surely?

Catra shook her head. She picked up a pair of scissors and cut the thread. It recoiled slightly, before knitting itself back together.

She kept trying to cut it in different places, but the same thing happened each time.

Catra knew where she had to cut.

She walked through to the kitchen again, holding herself with purpose. She selected a knife from the wooden block, placing her left hand on the chopping board, curling all her fingers under except one. She raised the knife and slammed down onto her finger, landing directly on the joint, just below the string.

It worked. The end of her finger lay on the chopping board, surrounded in a growing pool of blood.

A sense of relief washed over her. She was surprised by the lack of pain. She sighed and smiled.

An ugly scream tore through the house. For a second, Catra thought she had made it, but then realised it was Scorpia, standing in the doorway, covering her mouth. She looked so shocked, Catra almost laughed.

"C..Catra…" Scorpia stuttered. "What… What did you do?!"

Catra looked down at her hand, finally registering what she'd done. "Well… My red string appeared and I wanted to get rid of it. I'm not ready for a soulmate." She said, her voice trembling slightly.

"So you cut your finger off?!?" Scorpia shouted.

End Notes

thank you so much for reading! please leave a comment if you want to see more because i'm still on the fence as to wether i should even write this so a comment would be really helpful. thank you so much for reading and have a nice day!

the quote at the beginning is from John Berger's Ways Of Seeing.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!